

Deliverable #5: Sprint #1

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Executive Summary

To: Katherine Syvanych, Director - Center for Student Involvement

Prepared By: Talent-Link

Date: November 18, 2025

Talent-Link builds on our shared vision of a student-facing platform that strengthens peer-to-peer collaboration, highlights the wide range of skills across Kent State, and makes it easier for students to connect, collaborate, and grow together. This deliverable advances that vision by translating our earlier sprint planning into a clickable prototype and supporting documentation that gives you an idea of how the platform will look, feel, and function in practice. The prototype allows CSI to visualize both the student and admin experience and confirm that the system aligns with your engagement goals before moving on to the next sprint where we finalize the prototype.

- The updated Sprint Backlog reflects the team's progress so far and includes actual completion times for each task. In addition to the tasks originally planned for Sprint 1, we also added three more tasks that we were able to work ahead on (View Sessions, View Analytics, and Suggest Pairs prototypes), allowing us to reduce workload in Sprint 2.
- Our two Window Navigation Diagrams present the full structure of the user interface, mapping how students navigate across the student portal, and how admins navigate through the admin portal. This ensures that the platform's navigation is intuitive and that all major functions are logically connected.
- The Figma Prototype showcases the primary use cases that our team prioritized for sprint 1, including posting, suggesting pairs, matching with peers, viewing sessions, scheduling sessions, managing profiles, and moderating student activity and viewing analytics for admins. As of now, the prototype includes light interactivity such as an active sidebar that has hover states and links to appropriate pages, and pop ups that prompt users to take follow-up actions. This allows CSI to better imagine how students will engage with Talent-Link.
- The accompanying User Manual Videos provide a guided walkthrough of each use case in this sprint, explaining how users would engage with the system. We've included two separate user manual videos for students and admins to demonstrate the different portals and functionalities.
- Finally, the Detailed/Real Use Case Descriptions and Activity Diagrams compare the current focal use case process (Match with Peer), to the improved one that is enabled by Talent-Link, highlighting how the system reduces user friction and increases students participation.

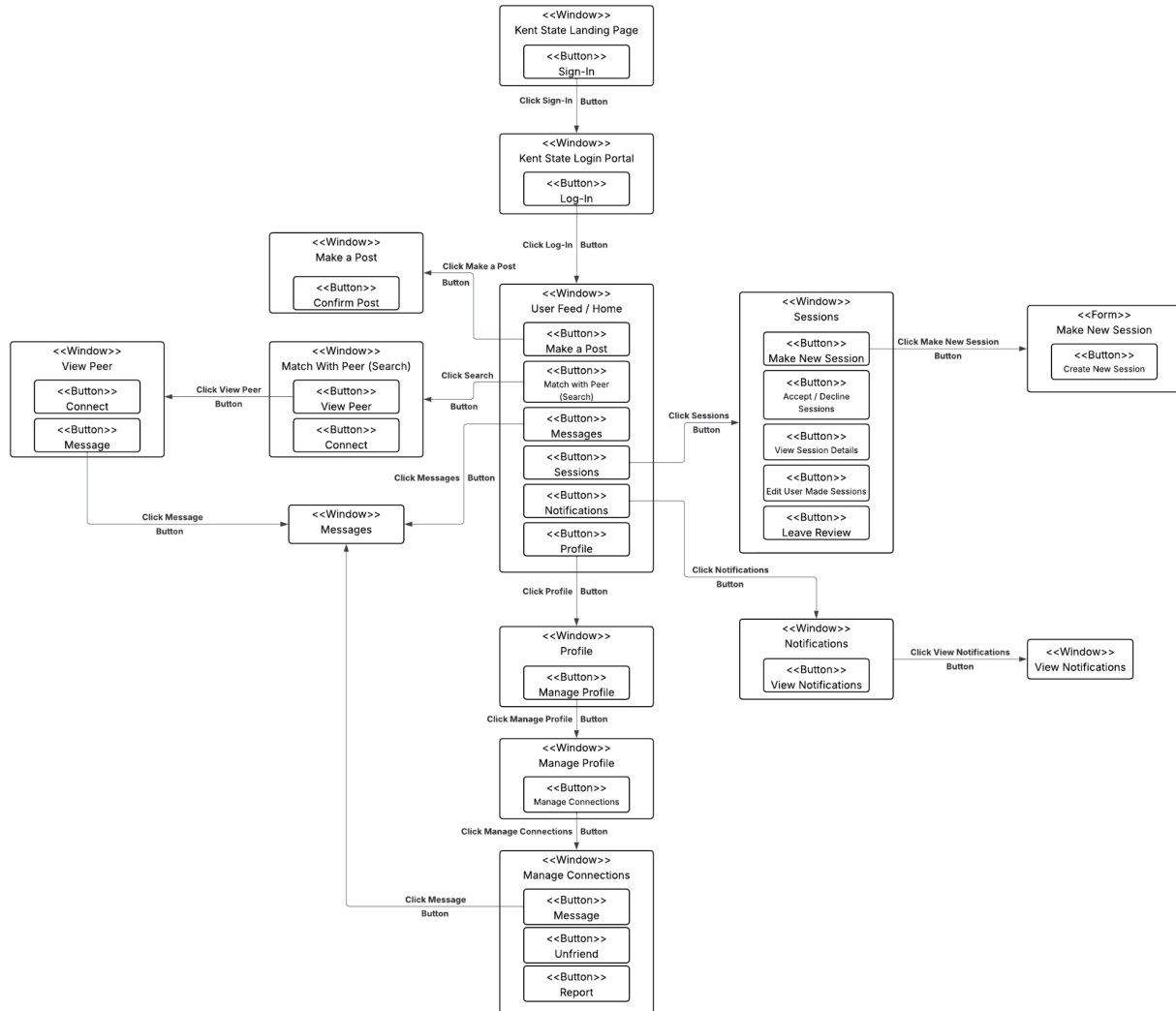
We invite your feedback on our prototype's current design to guide us in improving the quality of the final prototype in the next sprint. In sprint 2, our team will focus on completing the remaining use cases such as messaging and reviewing peers, as well completing a Network/Deployment Diagram, Cybersecurity Discussion, and a Cost-Benefit Analysis to finalize the system's foundation.

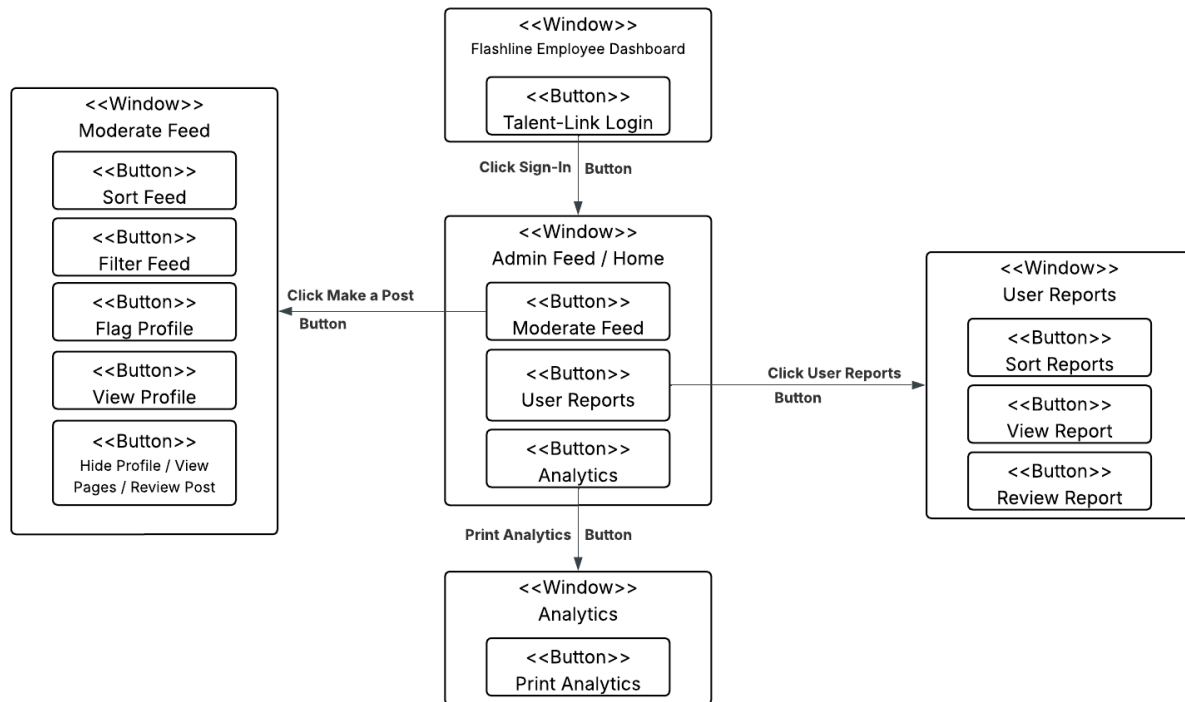
Updated Sprint 1 Backlog

Goal: Prototype essential student-focused use cases and the moderate platform activity use case for safety.			
Name of Task to be Completed	Team Member(s) Assigned Primary Responsibility	Estimated Effort for the Task (XXS-XXL)	Actual Completion Time
Match with Peer prototype	Grace	M	1 hour
Match with Peer UC Descriptions	Grace	L	1 hour
Match with Peer Activity diagrams	Lucy	L	2 hours
User Manual Video (student use cases)	Jordan	L	45 minutes
User Manual Video (Admin)	Lucy	M	30 minutes
Manage Profile Prototype	Akaiya	M	2 hours
Make a Post Prototype	Jordan	M	1 hour
View Sessions Prototype	Yusur	M	2 hours
Schedule Session Prototype	Yusur	M	1 hour
Suggest Pairs Prototype	Yusur	M	1 hour
Moderate Platform Activity Prototype	Lucy	M	2.5 hours
View Analytics Prototype	Lucy	M	30 minutes
D5 Executive Summary	Yusur	S	30 minutes
Window Navigation Diagram	Akaiya	XL	1 hour
D5 Appendix of Team Member Contributions	All	XXS	10 minutes
Update Sprint Backlog with actual completion times	All	XXS	10 minutes
Compile and finalize deliverable for submission	All	XS	20 minutes

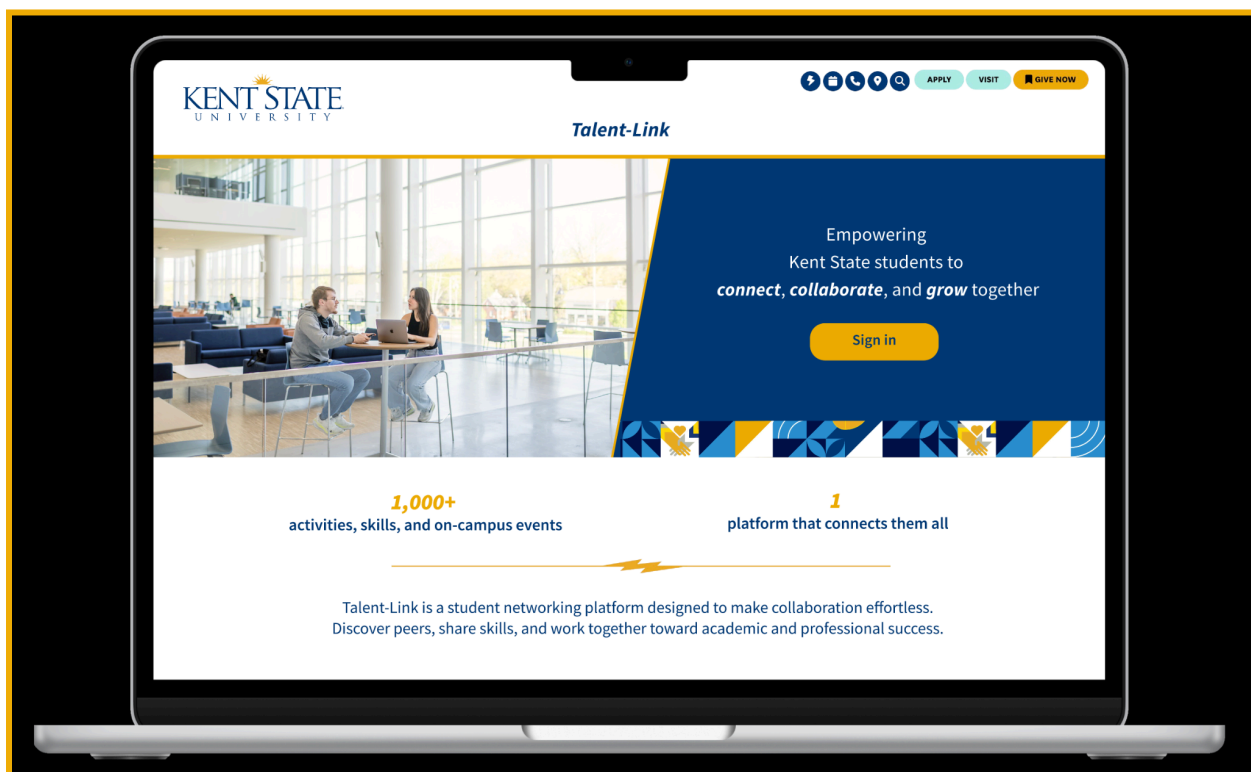
Window Navigation Diagram

User / Student Window Navigation Diagram:



Admin Window Navigation Diagram:

Talent-Link Prototype



Link to Prototype:

<https://www.figma.com/proto/F1X6EqtoYNcKw5iJeA13Oy/Talent-Link-Prototype?page-id=0%3A1&node-id=3-30&p=f&viewport=76%2C437%2C0.04&t=noqqMhbALB8RbFjp-1&scaling=scale-down&content-scaling=fixed&starting-point-node-id=3%3A30&show-proto-sidebar=1>

Prototype Viewing Instructions:

- No log in is needed to view this prototype.
- Once the prototype link is open, the **Student Flow** will display by default.
- If you would like to view the Admin Flow, navigate to the Flows panel in the left sidebar and select “**Admin Flow**.”
- Within the prototype, any interactive or clickable element will display a hand cursor on hover instead of the standard mouse cursor. This indicates that the object can be selected or navigated.
- To restart the prototype at any time, click the Restart button located in the bottom-right corner of the page. This will take you back to the first screen of the selected flow.

Video User Manuals

- **Student Manual:**

https://video.kent.edu/media/Talent+Link+Prototype+Student/1_p47brrly

*Note: If it switched to the video of me recording, please just push the switch button to make the prototype larger

- **Admin Manual:**

<https://youtu.be/jV0TgPmEF4Y>

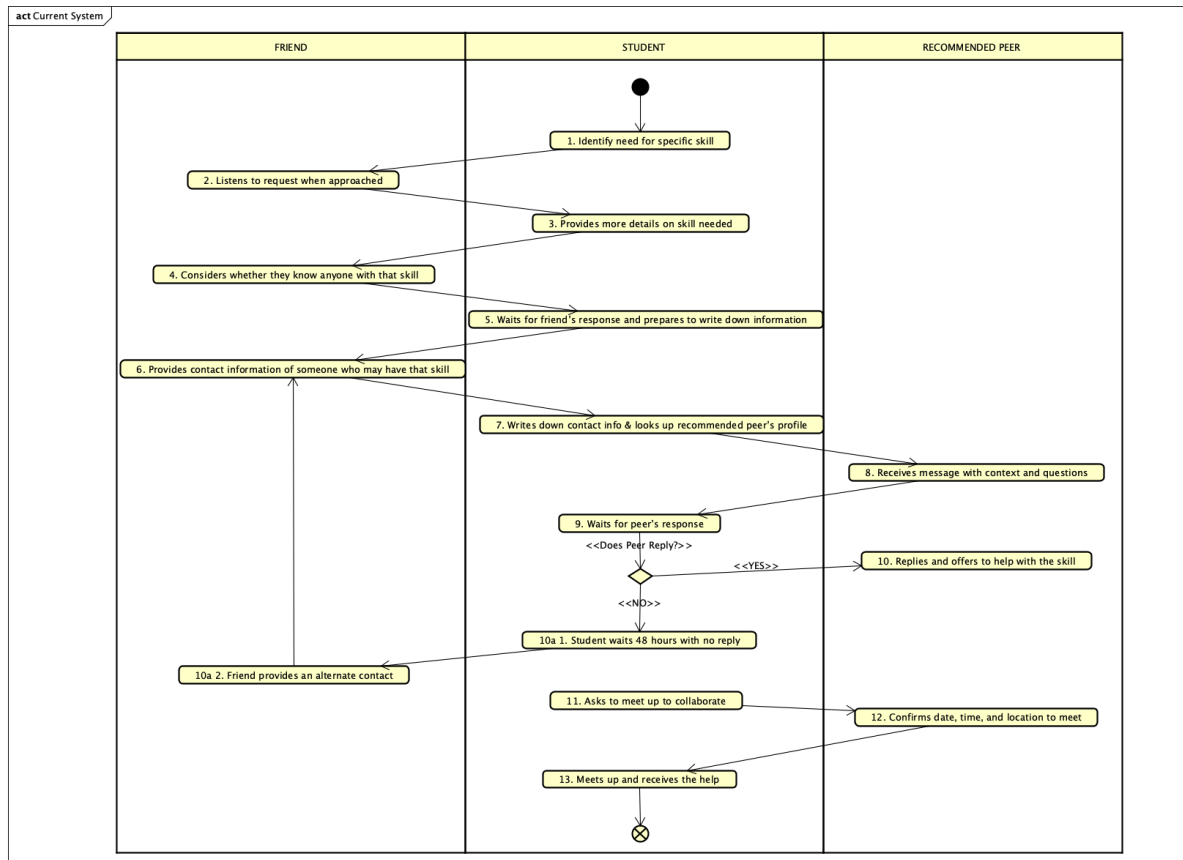
Use Case Descriptions: Current System

Use Case Name: Match with Peer	ID:	Importance Level: High
Primary Actor: Student	Use Case Type: Detail / Real	
Stakeholders and Interests: - Student: Want to efficiently find qualified peers for collaboration / learning skills. - Potential Peer Match: Want to connect with students who need their skills and gain collaborative opportunities. - CSI Directors: Want to support student success and foster collaboration on campus.		
Brief Description: In the current system, there is no formal matching pattern. Peers must connect with each other in real life through networking, group messages, asking around, or paying for a tutor. This process is slow, inconsistent, and unreliable.		
Trigger: A student realizes they need help learning a certain skill, or finding someone who excels in a specific area.		
Type: External		
Relationships: Association: Student ↔ Friend, Student ↔ Peer Include: N/A Extend: N/A Generalization: N/A		
Normal Flow of Events: 1. Student identifies a need for a specific skill in their academic, personal, or creative life. 2. Friend/Classmate is approached when the student reaches out and they listen to the request. 3. Student gives more details regarding the specific type of skill or help they need. 4. Friend/Classmate considers whether they know anyone with that skill. 5. Student waits for their friend’s response and prepares to write down information. 6. Friend/Classmate provides the contact information of someone who may have that skill. 7. Student writes down the contact info and later looks up the recommended peer’s profile. 8. Recommended Peer receives the student’s message with context and questions about the skill. 9. Student waits for the peer’s response. 10. Recommended Peer replies and offers to help with the skill. 11. Student thanks the peer and asks to meet up to collaborate. 12. Recommended Peer confirms the date, time, and location to meet. 13. Student meets up and receives the help they need, and use case concludes informally.		
SubFlows:		
Alternate/Exceptional Flows: 10a. Recommended peer doesn’t reply 1. Student waits 48 hours with no reply from suggested peer. 2. Student decides to go back to friend to request an alternative contact. 3. Resume at step 6 (Friend provides alternative contact information.)		

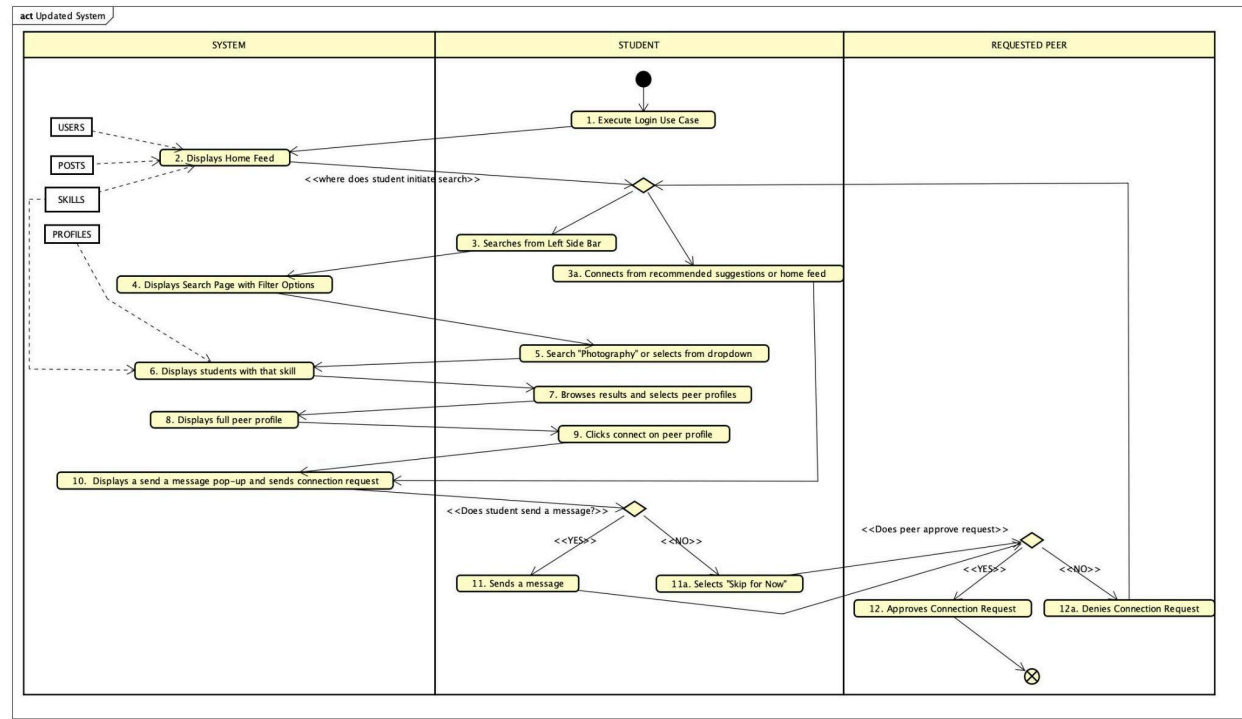
Improved System

Use Case Name: Match with Peer	ID:	Importance Level: High
Primary Actor: Student	Use Case Type: Detail / Real	
Stakeholders and Interests: - Student: Wants a fast, reliable way to find qualified peers with specific skills. - Potential Peer Match: Wants meaningful opportunities to share skills and collaborate. - CSI Directors: Want to streamline student collaboration through the platform.		
Brief Description: In the improved system, the student uses Talent-Link to search for peers based on verified skills and profiles. The system allows direct connection, messaging, and scheduling a collaboration session through an organized workflow. This eliminates the randomness and inefficiency of offline matching.		
Trigger: A student logs into Talent-Link after realizing they need help learning a specific skill. Type: External		
Relationships: Student and System, Students and Peers Association: Include: Extend: Generalization:		
Normal Flow of Events: 1. Student executes login use case after identifying a need for a specific skill. 2. System queries USERS, SKILLS, and POSTS database tables and displays the home feed with posts, left sidebar navigation, suggested peers on the right, and a “Create Post” option. 3. Student selects the Search tab from the left sidebar. 4. System displays the Search page with filter options for Major and Skills. 5. Student searches for “Photography” or selects it from the Skills dropdown filter. 6. System queries SKILLS and PROFILES tables and displays a list of students with that skill, including their name, profile picture, and mutual connections count. 7. Student browses results and selects a peer profile that might fit their needs 8. System retrieves and displays the peer’s full profile including their name, picture, graduation date, bio, and skills list. 9. Student clicks “connect” on peer’s profile 10. System displays a pop up prompting student to send a message and inputs connection request to selected user 11. Student executes send a message use case 12. Requested connection approves connection request		
SubFlows:		
Alternate/Exceptional Flows: 3a. Student selects connect from recommended profiles or feed 1. Student clicks connect on user’s post or AI algorithm suggestions 2. Proceed to step 10 11a. Student does not want to send message with request 1. Student clicks “Skip for now” 2. Proceed to step 12 12a. Requested connection denies connection request 1. Student restarts from step 3		

Current System Activity Diagram



Improved System Activity Diagram



Appendix of Team Member Contributions

Team Member	Percentage of Overall Work	Contributions
Grace Karpinski	20%	- Helped design match with peer prototype - Helped design match with peer UC description
Yusur Alrawi	20%	- Designed landing page & home page (branching out to our use cases) - Completed view sessions & schedule session prototypes - Designed example of peer profile - Set up figma interactions like pop ups and sidebar hover states
Lucy Hennessy	20%	- Completed Moderate Platform Activity prototypes - Completed user manual for moderator/admin use case - Completed the match with peer activity diagrams
Akaiya Abdullah	20%	- Completed Manage Profile prototype - Completed Window Navigation Diagram for both users and admin
Jordan Jenkins	20%	- Completed make a post prototype - Completed user manual for student use cases - Assisted with UC Descriptions - Helped compile final deliverable

1. **What collaboration approaches or software tools worked particularly well for your prototyping and documentation tasks that your team wants to continue using in Sprint 2, and why?**
 - a. Figma worked particularly well for our prototyping since it allows live collaboration and makes it easy for us to maintain design consistency. We'll continue using Figma to finalize our prototype in sprint 2.
2. **What didn't work so well, and what adjustments do you plan to make in response for Sprint 2?**
 - a. One thing we need to work on during Sprint 2 is the order and speed that we get certain tasks done. Some parts of the deliverable cannot be started until other parts are completed. During Sprint 2, we need to prioritize these tasks at the beginning so we do not fall behind. Now that we have a better understanding of how much effort some items actually take, it will be easier to readjust and reassign tasks.
3. **How did your team ensure that all team members contributed to, took accountability for, and learned about each part of the deliverable (and not just those pieces assigned primarily to them)?**
 - a. The main way we made sure everyone contributed to the assignment was doing the Sprint Backlog before the deliverable started so we knew who would be responsible for what, and to make sure the work was evenly distributed. We also make sure to have constant communication when we are working on anything, and after one person completes

something, the rest of the group will check it over, so we all have a full understanding of the deliverable.

4. **Were there any extenuating circumstances that led to an uneven distribution of the workload? (If so, explain how you plan to compensate for this in the final sprint.)**
 - a. We all had a part in the sprint, but some of us needed help with Figma so that we could complete this sprint
5. **Did you use any AI tools or other resources to generate or proofread any part of your final draft? If so, explain here (e.g., tell me what software or resources you used, & precisely how they were used).**
 - a. No AI tools were used in this deliverable.

Extra Credit Opportunity

Upon completion of our prototype, we sent a copy to Katie Syvanych, the director of the Center For Student Involvement. We have attached a screenshot of the conversation between Talent-Link and Katie.

